PAVEL CHERKASHIN

Corporate Development, Deal Lead • M&A & Strategic Investments • AI-Native Deal Ops • Operator & Investor

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Executive Thesis: *"Accelerating OpenAI's strategic inorganic growth through high-conviction M&A, transformative ecosystem partnerships, and AI-native deal operations. 20+ year transaction track record combining frontier venture investing ($100M+ deployed in AI and deep tech), corporate deal leadership (Adobe, Microsoft; architected landmark 1.5M+ seat transaction), and AI systems architecture. Pioneer of autonomous deal ops: deploying multi-agent networks to transform sourcing intelligence, synthetic diligence, automated decision memos, and post-merger integration into an asymmetric competitive moat."*

STRATEGIC FOCUS: INORGANIC GROWTH & AI-NATIVE DEAL OPERATIONS

OpenAI's Corporate Development team drives high-priority inorganic bets that expand research frontiers, secure critical infrastructure, and build enduring market leadership. As Deal Lead, I combine the rigorous transactional discipline of top-tier venture investing with hands-on technical fluency: evaluating proprietary model architectures, compute economics, and technical talent density. By embedding AI-native deal ops into every stage—sourcing radars, automated technical diligence, multi-scenario valuation models, and programmatic integration tracking—I compress transaction cycle times while eliminating execution risk across complex multi-party negotiations.

THE 6-MONTH CORPORATE DEVELOPMENT EXECUTION ARC

Months 1–2 **Sourcing & Pipeline**	**Thematic M&A Strategy & AI-Powered Sourcing:** Establish priority acquisition themes across foundational tooling, agent infrastructure, and vertical AI. Deploy autonomous sourcing radars scanning GitHub repos, research preprints, and venture pipelines to identify high-potential acquihire and tech targets before they enter competitive auction processes. Calibrate valuation heuristics with Finance and Legal.
Months 3–4 **Deal Execution**	**Transaction Structuring & Synthetic Diligence:** Lead end-to-end execution on 2–3 priority transactions (M&A, minority investments, compute-for-equity pacts). Implement synthetic due diligence pipelines automating code quality audits, IP provenance checks, and retention scenario modeling. Author crisp, data-backed Investment Committee memos and drive cross-functional consensus.
Months 5–6 **Integration & Scale**	**Seamless Integration Telemetry & Scaled Deal Ops:** Partner with Engineering and Product to execute 100-day post-close integration playbooks, tracking technical milestones and retention telemetry. Institutionalize autonomous deal ops infrastructure across the Corp Dev organization, enabling scalable, simultaneous execution across multiple concurrent transactions.

CORE TRANSACTIONAL & DEAL LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

- **End-to-End M&A & Deal Execution:** Full transaction ownership from origination, financial modeling, and diligence to definitive agreements, regulatory navigation, and closing.
- **Venture Capital & Founder Network:** Deep Silicon Valley and global VC network ($100M+ deployed); trusted relationships with top founders, investors, and technical innovators.
- **AI-Native Deal Operations:** Architect of multi-agent intelligence networks for automated deal scouting, synthetic diligence, automated decision memos, and integration tracking.
- **Cross-Functional Alignment:** Proven ability to unify Research, Product, Engineering, Legal, and Finance around high-stakes, time-sensitive inorganic transactions.

SELECTED CAREER TRACK RECORD & STRATEGIC DEAL LEADERSHIP

Managing Partner & Venture Capital Investor — *Mindrock Capital / Vestor.In* (2016–Present)

- **$100M+ Capital Deployed:** Led investments into frontier AI, deep-tech platforms, and high-performance computing infrastructure. Structured innovative venture notes, equity co-investments, and cross-border SPVs.
  - **Autonomous AI Deal Engine:** Built and deployed autonomous multi-agent pipelines automating market screening, thesis validation, cap-table modeling, and continuous investment telemetry.

Regional Director & Enterprise Licensing Executive — *Adobe Systems / Enterprise Operations*

- **Historic 1.5M+ Seat Agreement:** Conceived, negotiated, and executed the **largest single enterprise agreement in Adobe's corporate history** (1.5M+ licenses). Designed custom multi-tier revenue-sharing frameworks, complex legal structuring, and institutional delivery mechanisms setting a corporate precedent.

Technology Entrepreneur & Corporate Development — *Actis Systems / Microsoft Partner Network*

- Founded, scaled, and negotiated acquisitions for leading digital infrastructure firms. Led cross-border joint ventures, technology licensing alliances, and strategic corporate partnerships across US and international markets.

Venture Author & Global Mentor — *Founder Institute Alumnus (2014) & Academic Textbook Author*

- Authored authoritative university textbook on venture capital and enterprise creation. Mentored 5,000+ technology founders and operators; established active deal-sourcing pipelines across global venture ecosystems.

EDUCATION, QUANTITATIVE FOUNDATION & CREDENTIALS

- **Quantitative Foundation & Systems:** Applied Mathematics & Computer Science, Russian State University of Oil & Gas.
  - **Global Capital Network:** Founder Institute Silicon Valley Alumnus (2014); established relationships across US, European, and Asian VC and family offices.
  - **Executive Communication:** Fluent English, native Russian; veteran negotiator across diverse regulatory, antitrust, and legal frameworks.